



Delivery, POD & Getting Paid

Ace Dispatch · Dispatcher Training Course

Module 15 of 18 · Closing & Mastery · about a 16-minute read

Here's a hard truth that catches new dispatchers off guard: a load isn't finished when the trailer's empty. It's finished when the money hits the account. And there are two places it can fall apart right at the finish line.

First, the delivery itself. Marcus gets unloaded in Dallas — but he rolls away without a signed proof of delivery, and now you have no proof the freight ever arrived. Or two pieces show up damaged and nobody documents it right, and the carrier eats a claim that wasn't even its fault. Second, the money. The load delivered clean three weeks ago — but the invoice never went out. So the one thing all that work was *for* — getting paid — is just sitting there, unbilled, earning nobody anything.

The dispatcher's job at the end of a load is to close the loop: get the clean POD, get the invoice out fast and correct, and stay on the money until it lands in the account. Do that, and the load pays. Miss it, and you did all that work for free.

WHAT YOU'LL BE ABLE TO DO

Take a load across the real finish line: confirm a clean delivery and lock down the proof of delivery, handle it the right way when freight is short, damaged, or refused, and then turn that delivered load into money — invoicing the broker correctly, understanding when you'll be paid, and using factoring or quick pay to get cash sooner when you need it. In short: you'll know how the work actually becomes money.

1 The Load Isn't Done Until You're Paid

Every load ends the same way on paper: delivered and paid. Those are two separate jobs, and a load only truly closes when *both* are done. The first is the **delivery** — getting the freight off the truck and getting the document that proves it. The second is the **money** — billing for the load and actually collecting. Skip or fumble either one and the load doesn't pay, no matter how cleanly the truck ran. So your job at the end is to close the loop on both. Let's take delivery first, then the money.

2 The Delivery and the POD

The truck reaches the receiver and gets unloaded — a live unload where the driver waits, or a drop, just like you saw setting appointments, and the detention clock still applies if they hold him too long. But the thing that matters most at delivery isn't the unloading — it's the **POD**.

POD stands for **proof of delivery** — the document the receiver signs confirming the freight arrived. Usually it's the **bill of lading signed at the delivery end** (the same BOL from pickup, now signed by the receiver) or a delivery receipt. Think of it as the mirror image of pickup: at pickup, your driver signed for what he *received*; at delivery, the receiver signs for what *they* received.

PROOF OF DELIVERY (POD)

the pickup BOL, now signed by the receiver — the mirror image of pickup

RECEIVER	Dallas receiver
COUNTS & INSPECTS	20 pieces, against the BOL — same care as pickup
SIGNATURE	Clean, legible receiver signature GOLDEN TICKET
IF SHORT / DAMAGED	Note it <i>on the POD</i> — that notation is where any claim begins
THEN	Driver keeps the signed POD and gets it back to you quickly
No POD, no proof you delivered — and a broker will not pay without it. Getting it signed, complete, legible, and back to you fast is one of the most important things on the whole load.	

3 When Delivery Goes Wrong: Shortages, Damage, Refusals

Sometimes delivery isn't clean, and these are the situations to know:

Damage or shortage — you'll hear it called **OS&D, for over, short, and damaged**. A **shortage** is freight arriving with pieces missing against the BOL; **concealed damage** is damage nobody finds until the box is opened, which can surface even *after* delivery. Either one gets noted on the POD at delivery, and either one can trigger a **claim** — the shipper or broker seeking money for the loss. Your job is to make sure it's documented at delivery, report it up, and let the claim be handled properly. And here's where the pickup pays off: because your driver signed a *clean* BOL only after counting good freight, you have proof it left in good order — that's the carrier's protection against a bogus claim.

A refused load. The receiver won't take it — wrong product, damage, too late, no appointment. Do *not* just have the driver dump it or leave. Call the broker immediately; refusal is theirs to solve — a redelivery, a reconsignment to another receiver, or a return. You document everything and keep the driver put until the broker directs the next move.

SAME DISCIPLINE, DELIVERY EDITION

Notice the pattern is the one you already learned for problems on the road: *document it, communicate fast, and let the broker direct the freight*. A clean delivery needs a clean POD; a messy one needs careful documentation — and the clean pickup BOL is your shield either way.

4 Getting Paid: the Invoice and the Money Timeline

Now the money. Once the load is delivered, you **invoice** the broker — you bill them for the load. And you don't just send a number; you send the proof. A complete billing package is three things:

The invoice — your bill for the load.

+ **The signed rate confirmation** — the deal you're billing against.

+ **The POD** — proof the freight arrived. (Plus backup for any accessories — detention, a lumper receipt.)

Those documents together are your claim to payment, and the single biggest rule here is *invoice promptly*, because the clock to getting paid doesn't even start until you bill. What clock? The **payment terms**. Most brokers pay on terms, and the common one is **net-30** — payment is due about thirty days after they receive a proper invoice. So the real timeline of a load looks like this:



The "get cash sooner" branch — off the 30-day wait

Factoring (sell the invoice to a factor for ~95–97% now) **or quick pay** (the broker pays in ~2–3 days for a small discount). Either one turns next-month's money into cash this week.

Some brokers run net-15 or net-45; whatever it is, it was on the rate confirmation. And that thirty-day wait is the catch — your carrier already paid for fuel and the driver this week, but won't see the linehaul for a month. That's the **cash gap** the money lesson warned about.

DETENTION DESERVES ITS OWN PROCESS — THE ONE YOU'LL COLLECT MOST, AND MOST OFTEN LOSE

Detention is money owed when your driver waits past a facility's *free time* (the grace period, usually ~2 hrs) to be loaded or unloaded — at pickup *or* delivery. The money's real, but a broker only pays it when you can *prove* it:

- 1. Capture the times — or you can't bill them.** The driver records his *arrival and departure* times at the dock, documented in the moment: on the BOL/POD, through the facility's check-in/out, or as a time-stamped text. Waiting nobody wrote down is money you can't collect — this habit is the whole ballgame.
- 2. Know the terms — from the rate con.** The free time allowed and the detention rate (dollars per hour after free time) were spelled out on the rate confirmation you verified before dispatching.
- 3. Do the math, bill it with proof.** Billable detention = total dock time — free time × the rate. It goes on the invoice as a line item, with the documented times attached as backup — the same way the POD backs up the linehaul.

5 Bridging the Cash Gap: Factoring and Quick Pay

Two tools turn thirty-day money into money now.

Factoring. The carrier sells its unpaid invoice to a **factoring company**. The factor advances most of the money — often around ninety-five to ninety-seven percent — within a day or two, takes a small fee, and then collects the full amount from the broker when net-30 comes due. You hand over thirty-day money and get next-day cash for a price. (Remember the carrier packet? The factor needs its paperwork on file with the broker so the broker pays the *factor*, not the carrier.)

There's one distinction inside factoring you have to understand, and it comes straight back to vetting the broker:

Recourse factoring CHEAPER	Non-recourse factoring COSTS MORE
WHO CARRIES THE RISK If the broker never pays, the carrier has to buy the invoice back.	WHO CARRIES THE RISK The factor absorbs the loss if the broker can't pay (usually insolvency, not a dispute).
WHY THE PRICE The carrier carries the credit risk, so it's cheaper .	WHY THE PRICE The factor carries that risk, so it costs more .

That's exactly why a broker's credit score mattered when you vetted them: with recourse, a broker who doesn't pay becomes *your* problem.

Quick pay is the other route, and it skips the factor entirely: the *broker* offers to pay you early — say in two or three days — in exchange for a small discount off the rate, usually a few percent. No third party, just the broker paying fast for a cut. Your role across all of this: know which method your carrier uses, send the billing to the right place, and make sure the money actually shows up.

6 Close the Loop: Track and Reconcile

The last discipline, and it's the one that catches the money that would otherwise slip away. **Track the receivable** — don't assume payment is coming; confirm the invoice was received and watch for the deposit, and chase anything that ages past its terms. Then **reconcile**: when the money lands, check it against what you're owed — the rate con amount, plus any approved accessorials, minus anything already taken, like that fuel advance from dispatch and any factoring fee. If it's short, that's a **short-pay**, and you go back to the broker with your signed rate con in hand — the same document-check that protected you when you booked.

A load is not "done" when the truck is empty, and it's not done when you invoice. It's done when it's *paid and reconciled*. That's the finish line — and the moment you cross it, the only question that matters is what's keeping that truck busy next.

Walkthrough — Closing Out the Anchor Load

The on-time delivery, carried all the way to paid (anchor: Atlanta → Dallas, \$3,000, 20 pieces, net-30, Smith Logistics).

DELIVERY — DALLAS, THURSDAY 1:00 PM	
RECEIVER	Counts the 20 pieces — all there, no damage → signs the POD clean. ✓
MARCUS	Keeps the signed POD and sends it to you. <i>(If 2 were damaged: noted on the POD at delivery → claim process → your clean pickup BOL is the carrier's shield.)</i>

INVOICE — THEN BRIDGE THE CASH GAP

BILL SMITH Invoice for **\$3,000** + signed rate con + the POD (+ any accessorial backup). Terms: net-30 → paid ~30 days out.

FACTORING

Factor advances ~96% (~**\$2,880**) in a day, fee ~3-4%, collects from Smith at net-30. (Recourse: if Smith didn't pay, Summit buys it back — but Smith's credit was ~92, vetted solid.)

OR QUICK PAY Smith pays in ~2 days for ~3% off → ~**\$2,910**. No factor.

RECONCILE & CLOSE

CHECK Payment lands → check it vs the \$3,000 rate con, minus the ~\$400 fuel advance taken at dispatch and any fee.

Matches → load CLOSED. Short? → back to Smith with the rate con. Empty trailer was only the halfway point.

Follow the money, not just the truck: the 20 pieces became a clean POD, the POD plus the rate con became an invoice, and the invoice — factored or quick-paid — became cash, reconciled against what you were owed. *That's* a finished load.

Module 15 Glossary — your quick reference

The finish-line toolkit — proving delivery and turning it into money.

Proving the delivery

POD (proof of delivery)	The document the receiver signs confirming the freight arrived — usually the BOL signed at the delivery end. Your golden ticket to payment; a broker won't pay without it.
OS&D (over, short & damaged)	The catch-all for delivery discrepancies — extra, missing, or damaged freight. Noted on the POD; can trigger a claim.
Shortage / concealed damage	Pieces missing against the BOL (shortage), or damage found only when a box is opened, sometimes after delivery (concealed). Document at delivery.
Claim	A demand for money over a loss — short or damaged freight. Your clean pickup BOL is the carrier's protection against a bogus one.

Getting paid

Invoice	Your bill to the broker for the load — sent with the signed rate con and the POD. Invoice promptly; the payment clock starts at billing.
Net-30	Payment due about 30 days after a proper invoice is received — the common broker term (net-15 / net-45 also exist).
Recourse / non-recourse factoring	Recourse — the carrier buys the invoice back if the broker doesn't pay (cheaper). Non-recourse — the factor absorbs broker-insolvency loss (costs more).
Short-pay	A payment that lands short of what you're owed — caught by reconciling against the rate con, then disputed with it in hand.

Check yourself

Try these from memory first, then check your answers below.

1. **What is the POD, and why does it matter so much?**
2. **Two pieces arrive damaged. What happens, and what protects the carrier?**
3. **What do you submit to get paid, and what does net-30 mean?**
4. **What is factoring, and what's the difference between recourse and non-recourse?**
5. **A load was delivered two days ago. When is it truly "done"?**

ANSWERS

1. Proof of delivery — the document the receiver signs confirming the freight arrived (usually the BOL signed at delivery). It's your proof you delivered; brokers won't pay without it — the golden ticket to payment.
2. The damage is noted on the POD at delivery (that notation starts any claim); you report it and let the claim be handled. The clean BOL signed at pickup — proof the freight left in good order — is the carrier's protection.
3. A billing package — the invoice + signed rate con + POD (+ accessorial backup). Net-30 = payment due ~30 days after a proper invoice is received. Invoice promptly; the clock starts at billing.
4. Selling the unpaid invoice to a factor for most of the cash now (for a fee), so you don't wait net-30. Recourse = the carrier buys the invoice back if the broker doesn't pay (carrier's risk, cheaper); non-recourse = the factor absorbs broker-insolvency loss (factor's risk, costs more).
5. Not when the trailer's empty and not at invoicing — only when it's paid *and* reconciled against the rate con (catching any short-pay). Track the receivable until then.

WHAT'S NEXT → MODULE 16: KEEPING THE TRUCK LOADED

This load is delivered, the POD's in hand, the invoice is out — the money's coming. But here's what separates a good dispatcher from a great one: the second that truck is empty, it's *losing* money until it's loaded again. The best dispatchers never wait for a load to deliver before finding the next one — they're always thinking a move ahead, keeping the wheels turning and the revenue rolling. You've learned how a load ends; next, you learn how to make sure the truck never sits.

YOUR COMPANY'S PLAYBOOK

This lesson teaches close-out and billing as generic skills. Your own operation adds its specifics — its POD-collection process (how drivers send PODs, what's required, the deadline); its invoicing procedure and timing; whether it factors, with whom, recourse vs non-recourse, and the rate, or its quick-pay preferences; its claims process for OS&D; and how accounts receivable are tracked and reconciled, with short-pay follow-up. *Your trainer or supervisor will fill these in.*